

# Day 11: OSINT Dork Playbook

A consolidated, searchable reference — every dork used or catalogued so far, organized by use case and tagged so it's greppable later.

**Sources merged into this version:** Day 7 (Canva investigation), Day 10 (Freshworks multi-engine comparison), and the standing 50-query reference library. **Not yet merged — content not on hand:** Day 3, Day 8, Day 9. Drop those transcripts/files in and I'll fold them into the matching sections below rather than rebuilding the doc.

Legend: **[recon]** scoping/discovery · **[files]** document exposure · **[creds]** login/auth surfaces · **[infra]** API/config/infrastructure · **[platform]** third-party/cross-platform pivot

---

## 1. Recon & Site Scoping **[recon]**

General-purpose queries to map what a domain has exposed to the index before narrowing further.

| Dork                                                             | Purpose                                           | Notes / findings                                  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <code>site:example.com</code>                                    | Scope all search to one domain                    | Baseline for every other dork on this list        |
| <code>related:example.com</code>                                 | Find similar/competitor sites                     | From the reference library                        |
| <code>cache:example.com</code>                                   | View a cached snapshot of a page                  | Day 7 (Canva): cached pages available but limited |
| <code>site:example.com</code><br><code>intitle:"index of"</code> | Find open directory listings                      | Day 7 (Canva): none found — good indexing hygiene |
| <code>intitle:"index of"</code><br><code>"ebooks"</code>         | Open ebook directories (broad, not domain-scoped) | Reference library                                 |
| <code>intitle:"index of"</code><br><code>"software"</code>       | Open software directories (broad)                 | Reference library                                 |

## 2. File & Document Discovery **[files]**

| <b>Dork</b>                                                                                | <b>Purpose</b>                       | <b>Notes / findings</b>                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>site:example.com<br/>filetype:pdf</code>                                             | Locate public PDFs                   | Day 7 (Canva): design guides/docs indexed                   |
| <code>site:example.com<br/>filetype:pdf intitle:Canva<br/>-jobs -help</code>               | Narrow PDF search, strip noise terms | Day 7 — noise reduction pattern worth reusing on any target |
| <code>site:example.com<br/>filetype:pdf intitle:guide<br/>intext:design -help -blog</code> | Further noise-reduced doc search     | Day 7                                                       |
| <code>site:example.com<br/>filetype:doc OR<br/>filetype:docx</code>                        | Word documents                       | Reference library                                           |
| <code>site:example.com<br/>filetype:xls OR<br/>filetype:xlsx</code>                        | Excel documents                      | Reference library                                           |
| <code>site:example.com<br/>filetype:xlsx OR<br/>filetype:docx OR<br/>filetype:pptx</code>  | Combined office-doc sweep            | Day 7 — only public docs found on Canva                     |
| <code>site:example.com<br/>filetype:ppt</code>                                             | PowerPoint files                     | Reference library                                           |
| <code>site:example.com<br/>filetype:txt</code>                                             | Plain text files                     | Reference library                                           |
| <code>site:example.com<br/>filetype:csv</code>                                             | CSV exports                          | Reference library                                           |
| <code>site:example.com inurl:docs<br/>OR inurl:documentation<br/>filetype:pdf</code>       | Documentation specifically           | Day 7                                                       |
| <code>site:example.com<br/>filetype:pdf confidential</code>                                | Files with "confidential" in text    | Reference library — flag, don't act on hits                 |

|                                                                             |                             |                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------|
| <code>site:example.com<br/>filetype:xlsx budget</code>                      | Budget sheets               | Reference library |
| <code>site:example.com<br/>filetype:pdf report / "annual<br/>report"</code> | Reports / annual<br>reports | Reference library |
| <code>site:example.com "privacy<br/>policy" / "terms of service"</code>     | Legal/policy pages          | Reference library |
| <code>site:example.com "contact<br/>us"</code>                              | Contact pages               | Reference library |

**Live example (Day 10, Freshworks):** `site:freshworks.com filetype:pdf` turned up a legal "no-PE certificate" PDF and revealed an asset subdomain (`website-assets-fw.freshworks.com`) not present in the site's visible navigation — the clearest instance so far of a dork surfacing something Google's default results wouldn't have led to on its own.

### 3. Credential / Login Surfaces [creds]

Passive discovery of *where* auth surfaces live — never attempt login, brute force, or interaction with them.

| Dork                                                                        | Purpose              | Notes / findings                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <code>site:example.com inurl:login<br/>OR inurl:signin intitle:login</code> | Locate login portals | Day 7 (Canva): only official login pages found |
| <code>site:example.com inurl:login</code>                                   | Login-pattern URLs   | Reference library                              |
| <code>site:example.com inurl:admin</code>                                   | Admin-pattern URLs   | Reference library                              |
| <code>site:example.com<br/>intitle:"Login"</code>                           | Login-titled pages   | Reference library                              |
| <code>site:example.com<br/>intitle:"Dashboard" /<br/>inurl:dashboard</code> | Dashboard surfaces   | Reference library                              |
| <code>site:example.com inurl:portal</code>                                  | Portal pages         | Reference library                              |

|                                                                          |                                      |                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <code>site:example.com inurl:signin</code>                               | Sign-in pattern URLs                 | Reference library |
| <code>site:example.com inurl:auth</code>                                 | Auth endpoints                       | Reference library |
| <code>site:example.com<br/>intext:"username" /<br/>intext:"email"</code> | Credential-adjacent<br>text mentions | Reference library |
| <code>site:example.com<br/>"@example.com"</code>                         | Company email<br>address exposure    | Reference library |

## 4. API & Infrastructure [**infra**]

Open-web dorks for config/API exposure, plus what actually requires a dedicated infra-search platform instead.

| Dork / Query                                                                       | Purpose                              | Notes / findings                                                                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>site:example.com<br/>filetype:json OR<br/>filetype:xml<br/>intext:api</code> | Config file exposure                 | Day 7 (Canva): no sensitive configs observed                                                         |
| <code>site:example.com<br/>ext:xml / ext:log</code>                                | XML / log file exposure              | Reference library                                                                                    |
| <code>site:example.com "API"<br/>/ inurl:api</code>                                | API documentation and endpoints      | Reference/Day 7                                                                                      |
| <code>site:example.com<br/>"Magic Studio"<br/>AROUND(5) AI</code>                  | Proximity search for a named feature | Day 7 — <b>AROUND(n)</b> operator narrows to co-located terms, cuts noise vs. a plain keyword search |

**Key limitation surfaced in Day 10:** Shodan and Censys queries (e.g. `product:nginx, services.tls.certificates.leaf_data.subject.organization:"X"`) only return usable host/banner/certificate data *inside those platforms' own search index* — running the equivalent phrase through a general web search only returns their documentation, never actual target infrastructure. Same story for crt.sh subdomain enumeration (`%.example.com` wildcard query) — has to be run directly against the tool, not discovered through a web search about it. Budget separate time/access for these; they are not a dork you can run from a regular search bar.

## 5. Platform-Specific Pivots [platform]

Leaving the target's own domain to search where it's discussed, mirrored, or where the people behind it show up unfiltered.

| Dork                                                                                                                                    | Purpose                                                | Notes / findings                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>site:linkedin.com</code><br><code>"Data Scientist"</code><br><code>"Bangalore"</code>                                             | Role/location-scoped LinkedIn search                   | Reference library — swap in target's real roles/cities                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <code>site:github.com</code><br><code>example.com</code>                                                                                | Code/repo mentions of the domain                       | Reference library                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <code>site:stackoverflow.com</code><br><code>"Python Selenium"</code>                                                                   | Technical Q&A mentions                                 | Reference library                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <code>site:medium.com</code><br><code>"Google Dorking"</code>                                                                           | Blog/article mentions                                  | Reference library                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <code>site:docs.google.com</code><br><code>"project plan" /</code><br><code>site:drive.google.com</code><br><code>"presentation"</code> | Publicly shared Google Docs/Drive files                | Reference library — a frequent accidental-exposure vector                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <code>site:pastebin.com</code><br><code>example.com</code>                                                                              | Paste-site leaks/references                            | Reference library                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <code>site:archive.org</code><br><code>example.com</code>                                                                               | Historical/archived captures                           | Reference library                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Name search → personal social account (e.g. <code>"Girish Mathrubootham"</code><br><code>Freshworks CEO</code> )                        | Identity pivot from official bio to informal footprint | Day 10 — surfaced the founder's personal X account: hometown, current city, personal opinions, fandom posts, none of which showed up in the corporate-bio results. Functions the same way a reverse-image search does: pivot off an identity anchor to jump from sanitized "official" material to unpolished personal material |

## 6. Broad/Unscoped Reference Queries (not domain-specific)

Kept separate since these aren't scoped to a single target — useful for topic sweeps rather than investigating one organization.

| Dork                                            | Purpose                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| "machine learning" filetype:pdf                 | ML-related PDFs, any domain             |
| "cybersecurity" filetype:ppt                    | Cybersecurity presentations, any domain |
| "python automation" filetype:pdf                | Python guides, any domain               |
| site:edu filetype:pdf "artificial intelligence" | Academic AI papers                      |
| site:gov filetype:pdf cybersecurity             | Government cybersecurity docs           |
| site:who.int COVID-19 filetype:pdf              | WHO documents                           |
| site:nasa.gov filetype:pdf                      | NASA PDFs                               |
| allintext:"machine learning" "python"           | Strict all-keywords-in-body search      |

---

### Working notes / house rules

- Always start [recon], narrow into [files]/[creds]/[infra] once the domain's scope is understood.
- [creds] hits are for *mapping surface area only* — locating a login page is the entire scope; no further interaction.
- [infra] findings on the open web are usually just documentation about a tool, not the tool's data — don't mistake a Shodan/Censys doc page for an actual finding.
- Negative terms (-jobs -help -blog) and proximity operators (AROUND(n)) are the two easiest ways to cut noise on a common target name — both proved out in Day 7.